

GENERAL KNOWLEDGE

(STANDARD GK)

INDIA & THE WORLD

MODULE – 18

INDIA ... WORLD HERITAGE SITES

CULTURAL ... PART - 2



GUJARAT

MADHYA PRADESH

MAHARASHTRA

CHHATTISGARH

TELANGANA

KARNATAKA

GOA

ELEPHANTA CAVES

Arabian Sea

Bay of Bengal

ELEPHANTA CAVES



WORLD HERITAGE SITES - CULTURAL

8. ELEPHANTA CAVES



ELEPHANTA CAVES

SALIENT POINTS

- It is the 'City of Caves', on an island near Mumbai.
- It contains a collection of rock art linked to the cult of Shiva.
- Here, Indian art found one of its most perfect expressions, particularly the huge high reliefs in the main cave.
- The rock-cut Elephanta Caves were constructed about the mid-5th to 6th centuries A.D.

WORLD HERITAGE SITES - CULTURAL

8. ELEPHANTA CAVES



ELEPHANTA CAVES

SALIENT POINTS

- These hills are also known as “Gharapuri”.
- The Cave 1 is most impressive which represents the evolved Brahmanical rock-cut architecture.
- On plan it almost resembles the Dumar Lena i.e., Cave 29 of Ellora.



GUJARAT

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ELLORA CAVES



WORLD HERITAGE SITES - CULTURAL

9. ELLORA CAVES



ELLORA CAVES

SALIENT POINTS

- Ellora Caves are in Aurangabad district of Maharashtra.
- There are 34 monasteries and temples, extending over more than 2 km.
- They were dug side-by-side in the wall of a high basalt cliff.
- They are uninterrupted sequence of monuments from 600 A.D. to 1000 A.D.
- It is unique artistic creation with its sanctuaries devoted to Buddhism, Hinduism and Jainism.

WORLD HERITAGE SITES - CULTURAL

9. ELLORA CAVES



ELLORA CAVES

SALIENT POINTS

- It illustrates the spirit of tolerance that was characteristic of ancient India.
- It is also world famous for the largest single monolithic excavation in the world, the Great Kailasa (Cave 16).
- These are hewn out of volcanic basaltic formation of Maharashtra, known as “Deccan Trap”.
- These have a glimpse of the channels through which the volcanic lava once flowed.



GREAT KAILASA (CAVE 16)

WORLD HERITAGE SITES - CULTURAL

9. ELLORA CAVES



ELLORA CAVES

SALIENT POINTS

- These channels, due to overheating, have a characteristic brownish red colour.
- They are part of the Sahyadri ranges of the Deccan.
- Caves 1 to 12 are Buddhist; Caves 13 to 29 are Brahmanical and Caves 30 to 34 are Jains.
- The majority of the Brahmanical establishments can be attributed to the Rashtrakuta times and indicate the religious tolerance.



UTTARAKHAND

HARYANA

DELHI

N E P A L

FATEHPUR SIKRI

RAJASTHAN

UTTAR PRADESH

BIHAR

JHARKHAND

MADHYA PRADESH

CHHATTISGARH

FATEHPUR SIKRI



WORLD HERITAGE SITES - CULTURAL

10. FATEHPUR SIKRI



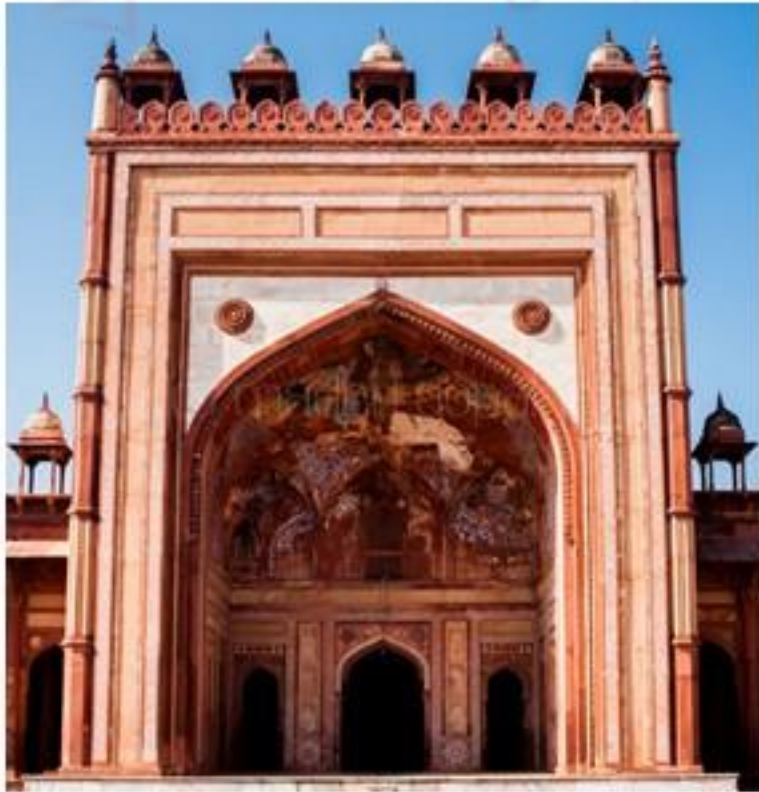
FATEHPUR SIKRI

SALIENT POINTS

- It was built in the second half of the 16th century by the Mughal Emperor, Akbar.
- Fatehpur Sikri means the City of Victory.
- It was the capital of the Mughal Empire for around 10 years.
- The complex of monuments and temples, all in a uniform architectural style includes one of the largest mosques in India, the Jama Masjid.

WORLD HERITAGE SITES - CULTURAL

10. FATEHPUR SIKRI



FATEHPUR SIKRI

SALIENT POINTS

- It was the first planned city of the Mughals.
- Sikri is an extension of upper Vindhyan ranges and is situated on the bank of a large natural lake.
- The Architecture of Fatehpur Sikri has a definite all-India character.
- It is prolific and versatile Indo-Muslim composite style, which is a fusion of the composite cultures of indigenous and foreign origins.

Arabian Sea

Bay of Bengal

ANDHRA PRADESH

KARNATAKA

TAMIL NADU

KERALA

GREAT LIVING CHOLA TEMPLES



GREAT LIVING CHOLA TEMPLES



WORLD HERITAGE SITES - CULTURAL

11. GREAT LIVING CHOLA TEMPLES



Great Living Chola Temples

SALIENT POINTS

- These are situated in Tamil Nadu built by the Kings of Chola Empire in South India.
- They include three famous 11th and 12th century Temples i.e., Brihadisvara Temple at Thanjavur, the Brihadisvara Temple at Gangaikondacholisvaram and the Airavatesvara Temple at Darasuram.
- The Temple of Gangaikondacholisvaram, was built by Rajendra I, and completed in 1035.

WORLD HERITAGE SITES - CULTURAL

11. GREAT LIVING CHOLA TEMPLES

SALIENT POINTS

- The Airavatesvara temple complex was built by Rajaraja II, at Darasuram features 24 m vimana and stone image of Shiva.
- The temples signify the brilliant achievements of the Chola in architecture, sculpture, painting and bronze casting.
- The Great Cholas established a powerful monarchy in 9th century at Thanjavur.
- The tradition of temple worship and rituals established and practised over a thousand years based on still older Agamic texts.



Airavatesvara Temple, Darasuram

WORLD HERITAGE SITES - CULTURAL

11. GREAT LIVING CHOLA TEMPLES



Brihadisvara Temple, Thanjavur

SALIENT POINTS

- Brihadisvara temple is also known as Dakshina Meru.
- It is regarded as a landmark in the evolution of building art in South India and its Vimana as the touchstone of Indian architecture as a whole.
- The Temple with its massive proportions has provided inspiration for future designs in constructions not only in South India but also in South-East Asia.



Brihadisvara Temple, Gangaikondacholisvaram

Arabian Sea

Bay of Bengal

ANDHRA PRADESH

KARNATAKA

THE AIRAVATESVARA TEMPLE

DARASURAM

BRIHADISVARA TEMPLE

GANGAIKONDA CHOLAPURAM

BRIHADISVARA TEMPLE

THANJAVUR

TAMIL NADU

KERALA





MAHARASHTRA

TELANGANA

KARNATAKA

Arabian Sea

GOA

GROUP OF MONUMENTS AT HAMPI

ANDHRA PRADESH

TAMIL NADU

KERALA

GROUP OF MONUMENTS AT HAMPI



WORLD HERITAGE SITES - CULTURAL

12. GROUP OF MONUMENTS AT HAMPI



MONUMENTS AT HAMPI

SALIENT POINTS

- It is in Karnataka.
- It was the capital of the last great Hindu Kingdom of Vijayanagar.
- It built Dravidian temples and palaces, which won the admiration of travellers between the 14th and 16th centuries.
- It was located in the Tungabhadra basin in Central Karnataka.
- Dravidian architecture flourished under the Vijayanagara Empire.



■ the Gopura too resembles a Mandala; With sculptures and carvings of Yalis and mythical animals located in the outer enclosure.

■ Humans and divine beings are in the inner enclosures.

■ The peak of the Gopura, the Kalasha, is at the centre of the Mandala



DRAVIDIAN ARCHITECTURE

WORLD HERITAGE SITES - CULTURAL

12. GROUP MONUMENTS AT HAMPI

SALIENT POINTS

- It is characterised by their massive dimensions, cloistered enclosures, and lofty towers over the entrances encased by decorated pillars.
- The Vittala temple is the most exquisitely ornate structure.
- The wide Chariot streets flanked by the rows of Pillared Mandapas and chariot festivals became an integral part of the rituals.
- Most of the structures at Hampi are constructed with local granite, burnt bricks and lime mortar.
- The Battle of Talikota (1565 CE) led to massive destruction of its physical fabric.



MONUMENTS AT HAMPI



VITTALA TEMPLE

Arabian Sea

Bay of Bengal

ANDHRA PRADESH

KARNATAKA

TAMIL NADU

KERALA

**GROUP OF MONUMENTS AT
MAHABALIPURAM**



THE GROUP OF MONUMENTS AT MAHABALIPURAM



WORLD HERITAGE SITES - CULTURAL

13. THE GROUP OF MONUMENTS AT MAHABALIPURAM



MONUMENTS AT MAHABALIPURAM

SALIENT POINTS

- These are founded by the Pallava kings.
- Carved out of rock along the Coromandel coast in the 7th and 8th centuries.
- Known for its rathas, temples in the form of chariots, mandapas, cave sanctuaries, giant open-air reliefs.
- Mamallapuram is after the title of great Pallava ruler Narasimhavarman-I.



GIANT OPEN-AIR RELIEFS

WORLD HERITAGE SITES - CULTURAL

13. THE GROUP OF MONUMENTS AT MAHABALIPURAM



MONUMENTS AT MAHABALIPURAM

SALIENT POINTS

- It was a sea-port during the time of Periplus (1st century A.D.) and Ptolemy (140 A.D.) and many Indian colonists sailed to South-East Asia through this port town.
- Of the nine monolithic temples found in Mahabalipuram, the most important are Five Rathas known after the famous five Pandava brothers of the Mahabharata fame.
- The structural architecture was introduced on a grand scale by Pallava Rajasimha (AD 700-28), culminating in the erection of the world famous Shore temple.



FIVE RATHAS OF MAHABALIPURAM

Arabian Sea

GOA

GROUP OF MONUMENTS AT PATTADAKAL

MAHARASHTRA

TELANGANA

ANDHRA PRADESH

KARNATAKA

TAMIL NADU

KERALA

GROUP OF MONUMENTS AT PATTADAKAL



WORLD HERITAGE SITES - CULTURAL

14. GROUP OF MONUMENTS AT PATTADAKAL



MONUMENTS AT PATTADAKAL

SALIENT POINTS

- These are in Karnataka.
- It represents the high point in 7th and 8th centuries under the Chalukya Dynasty.
- It blended architectural forms from North and South India.
- It constitutes 9 Hindu Temples as well as a Jain Sanctuary.

WORLD HERITAGE SITES - CULTURAL

14. GROUP OF MONUMENTS AT PATTADAKAL



VIRUPAKSHA TEMPLE

SALIENT POINTS

- The Temple of Virupaksha built in 740 A.D. by Queen Lokamahadevi to commemorate her husband's victory over the kings from the South.
- The Sangamesvara, the earlier of the three was built by Chalukya Vijayaditya and it is nearer to Pallava form in that it has no sukanasika, while the other two, which possess this, are the earliest of the Chalukyan type.

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